

Growing with Gritty

Your website — where it stands, and what happens next

Build Grit. Grow Strong. Never Quit!



What I've done so far

3

Three full design versions

Each one built and clickable, not a mockup — so you can react to something real.

20+

Sites and studies reviewed

The best children's book sites in the world, and what child-development research says actually works.

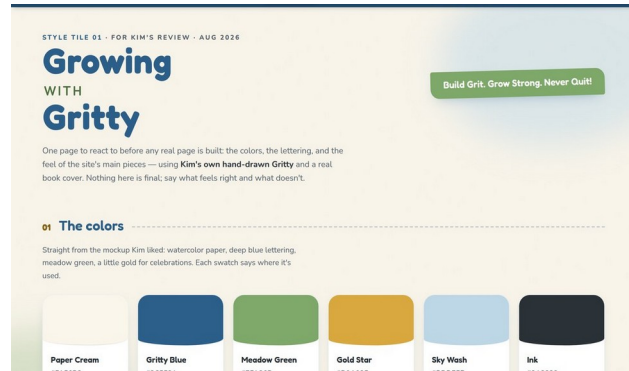
9

Pages already built

Home, Meet Gitty, a page for each of your four books, About You, and the Grown-Up Grit Guide.

Nothing is decided. You pick the direction — and mixing pieces from different versions is a perfectly good answer.

Three directions I built for you



Version 1

The Sheet

A calm sample page: your colors, your lettering, one book card. Everything sits still.



Version 2

The Meadow

The page becomes a place. Gritty stands in a meadow and reacts when children tap him.



Version 3

Alive

Gritty breathes and his lines shimmer like hand-drawn animation. Every activity rebuilt around the research.

MY PICK

All three are live — you can click between them at the top of any page.

Why the research changed my mind

Three things I built into Version 2 turned out to work against your books. Version 3 undoes them.

1

Sticker charts that show what you haven't earned yet

Locked grey stickers actually reduce a child's own motivation. Now stickers only appear for what a child has already done — souvenirs, never a scoreboard.

2

Rewarding a child for pressing "YET"

The moment encouragement pays out, it becomes a transaction. Pressing YET now earns nothing at all.

3

"YET!" on its own

Carol Dweck calls effort-praise with no strategy "false growth mindset." Now Gritty names the real thing — "you can't tie your laces... yet" — and offers one idea to try.

What the research actually says

These are large studies, not opinions — and they shaped real decisions on your site.

128

experiments

showed promised rewards
reduce children's own
motivation.

1,978

children

showed tap-to-play features do
nothing for story understanding
— games made it worse.

43

studies

found the harm falls hardest on
children with least support at
home.

This is a claim you can make that no competitor can: “there’s nothing to tap during the story — and here’s the research why.” Teachers forward that.

Your drawing, brought to life

On Version 3, Gitty breathes, and his outline shimmers the way hand-inked cartoons do — all from the single drawing you already gave me. Nothing was redrawn by a computer.

What I'd love you to draw

- Gitty with his eyes closed — just the two eyes, so he can blink
- Trace your own Gitty twice, as close as you can — that makes his lines shimmer for real

That's it. Two small things.

Blinking is the single strongest sign of life a character can have — old animation studios cut arms and legs from cartoons so they could afford to animate the eyes.

ride my bike

tie my laces

read big words

do a cartwheel

share my toys

I can't tie my laces... **YET!**

YET!

One thing that might help:

Try the bunny-ears way instead. A different way is not cheating.



Said hi to Gitty



Tried the Tower



Asked for an idea



Named a hard thing

Your stickers live inside this computer, in this browser. Nobody else can see them — not even us. If you use a different computer, or clear your browser, they'll be gone. That's okay.

 [Print my shelf](#) [Start my shelf over](#)

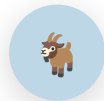
The site itself is already built

Nine working pages, waiting on your final artwork and buy links.



Home

Gritty welcomes visitors, the four values, all four books



Meet Gritty

Gritty and his whole family, and “what is grit?”



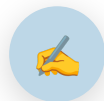
Your books

One page per book — story, lesson, characters, a grit challenge



Grown-Up Grit Guide

Free printables and conversation starters for parents and teachers



About you

Your story as a teacher, author and illustrator



Nothing collected

No sign-ups, no ads, no tracking — anywhere on the site

It is not on the internet yet — that happens when you’re happy with the look and we point the web address at it.

How you'll change things yourself

No code, ever. You fill in a form on a web page, press Save, and the site updates in about two minutes.

1

Open one bookmark

A page called Pages CMS. You sign in once and never think about it again.

2

Pick what to change

A simple list down the side: Books, Characters, Printables, Home page, About.

3

Type in the boxes

Same as filling in a form. Upload a PDF or a drawing by dragging it in.

4

Press Save

Two minutes later it's live for everyone. Every version is kept, so nothing is ever lost.

You can't break it. A half-finished form just doesn't show that bit yet — and any change can be undone.

The web address: polkadotbackpack.com

Heads up — that address is already in use. It currently points at a Shopify store, and www points somewhere different again. So before anything moves, I need to know what's there.

What I need from you

- Where did you buy it? (GoDaddy, Namecheap, Shopify...)
- The login for that account — or you drive and I'll talk you through it
- What's on the Shopify store now, and is it staying?
- Do you want an email address there, like kim@polkadotbackpack.com?

The choice to make

A

Gitty takes the main address

polkadotbackpack.com becomes the book site; the shop moves to shop.polkadotbackpack.com

B

Gitty gets its own address

The store stays exactly as it is, and the books live somewhere like growingwithgitty.com

Once that's decided the technical side is about twenty minutes, and the site gets a padlock (https) automatically — free, forever.

What I need from you



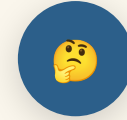
Drawings

- Gitty with closed eyes (just the eyes)
- Two traces of your own Gitty
- Portraits of Grandpa, Gabby, Grandma, Gibby
- Photos of your book pages, inside



Words & files

- Where people buy each book
- Your first coloring pages as PDFs
- Anything you'd change in the words I wrote



Decisions

- Which version you like — or which bits of each
- What happens to the Shopify store
- Whether you want school-visit info on the site

None of it is urgent, and none of it has to arrive together. Send things as you finish them.

What happens next

Now

You pick a direction

Look at all three on your phone. Tell me what feels right and what doesn't.

Then

I finish the look

I apply your choice across every page and send it back to you.

Next

We sort the address

Twenty minutes together to point polkadotbackpack.com where we agree.

Then

You get the keys

I set up your editing page and walk you through it once on a call.

After

Gritty's World

The activities — the Grit Zone, the Calm Corner, the Power of YET.

"There's no hurry. Gritty will be here."